Akanksha Sharma
Data Analytics Specialist - Institutional Research & Planning
POWER BI | SQL | PYTHON | TA B L E A U
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Portfolio: sharmauncw.github.io

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data analytics professional with more than six years of full-time experience turning data into decisions across fintech, automotive data, government IT, consulting, and higher-education institutional research. Currently Data Analytics Specialist in the University of North Carolina Wilmington's Office of Institutional Research & Planning - building institutional reports and dashboards, strengthening data quality, and partnering with campus stakeholders. Doctor of Information Technology (DIT) doctoral student at Trine University (4.00 GPA).

EXPERIENCE

Data Analytics Specialist - University of North Carolina Wilmington May 2026 - Present
Full-time | Wilmington, NC (On-site)
Support data-informed decision-making across the university by building and maintaining institutional reports and dashboards.
Ensure data quality and consistency across analytical outputs. Partner with campus stakeholders to clarify reporting requirements and communicate findings in accessible language. Apply SQL, Python, Tableau, and statistical analysis to institutional analytics use cases. Designated Community Expert in AI Currents, UNCW's internal AI community on Viva Engage - one of six designated experts in a 103-member community (verified Oct 27, 2026).

Consultant - Source Mantra Aug 2024 - Jun 2025
Full-time | Remote
Delivered client-focused data and analytics support using Python and SQL for reporting, analysis, and business problem-solving.
Performed statistical analysis to identify patterns and translate results into stakeholder-ready insights. Partnered with remote stakeholders to align deliverables to requirements.

Intern - MOTOR Information Systems Sep 2023 - Aug 2024
Internship | Hybrid (Troy, MI)
Completed a year-long hybrid internship supporting data initiatives in the automotive information space. Assisted with data organization, validation, and reporting support. Built automotive data context that informed subsequent Power BI dashboard development.

Backend Data Specialist - CredAble Jun 2020 - Nov 2022
Full-time | Remote (Mumbai Metropolitan Region, India)
Managed backend data operations for a fintech company with emphasis on dependable data processing, organization, and accuracy. Supported database work, data maintenance, and issue resolution. Collaborated cross-functionally to improve data usability for business reporting.

Technical Data Associate - Fast Enterprises, LLC Jan 2016 - Dec 2018

Full-time | On-site (Atlanta, GA)
Supported government IT implementations with data conversion, validation, and reporting.
Provided technical data support, issue
resolution, and operational delivery with attention to data integrity and stakeholder service.
Engineering Co-op - Technicolor Aug 2012 - Aug 2015
Purdue University co-op program
Completed 4 of 5 co-op terms through Purdue's co-op program.
Campus Ambassador - McGraw Hill Aug 2014 - May 2015
Purdue University
Student Ambassador promoting McGraw Hill learning products and resources on campus.
SPEAKING
Guest Lecturer - "Data Visualization (Session 1)" Oct 14, 2026
EDL 586/686 Program Evaluation, Watson College of Education, UNCW
Delivered a mini-lecture plus a hands-on "Bad Data Clinic" activity via Zoom; invited by Dr.
Satlaj Dighe.
Guest Lecturer - "Before You Trust a Number (Session 2)" Oct 28, 2026
EDL 586/686 Program Evaluation, Watson College of Education, UNCW
Delivered a 35-minute Zoom session on judging whether a number can be trusted before it is
released - data recipes and
snapshots, verification checks, and governance - with a live Tableau demonstration and
anonymous student polls; invited by Dr.
Satlaj Dighe.
PROJECTS

Akanksha Sharma

IPEDS Outcomes Lab - Python | Machine Learning | SHAP | github.com/sharmauncw/ipeds-outcomes-lab
Built an outcomes-modeling lab on the federal IPEDS panel, 2015-2023: 60,885 institution-years
across 8,670 institutions.
Graduation-rate model: R2 0.745, MAE 7.15 percentage points. First-year retention is the top
SHAP driver of graduation rates (9.49).
Pell vs. non-Pell 8-year award rates: 45.9% vs. 62.2% - a 16.4-percentage-point gap (IPEDS
Outcome Measures, student-
weighted).
Student Success Benchmark - Power BI | DAX | Python | Streamlit |
github.com/sharmauncw/student-success-benchmark
Peer-benchmarked student-success analytics on synthetic data: a star-schema model with DAX
measures and an interactive
Streamlit/Plotly demo.
Streaming Content Analytics - Python | scikit-learn | DuckDB | SQL |
github.com/sharmauncw/streaming-content-analytics
End-to-end analysis of the MovieLens catalog and ratings: pandas EDA, k-means catalog
segmentation, a content-based
recommender, and analytical SQL in DuckDB.
Retail Sales Forecasting - Python | Holt-Winters | DuckDB |
github.com/sharmauncw/retail-sales-forecasting
Ninety-day sales forecast with confidence bands on synthetic retail data: Holt-Winters

exponential smoothing, residual-based
anomaly detection, and a DuckDB analytics mart for month-over-month store and category performance.
Automotive Repair Data Dashboard - Power BI | SQL Server | SQL
Interactive Power BI dashboard for automotive repair data, built with reusable Power Query transformations and DAX measures for
KPIs, trends, and time intelligence on a fact/dimension semantic model.
Bad Chart Clinic - Python | Matplotlib | github.com/sharmauncw/bad-chart-clinic
Six pairs of misleading vs. corrected data visualizations with numerically honest fixes - a teaching clinic for honest chart design.
Talking Resume Pipeline - Python | github.com/sharmauncw/talking-resume-pipeline
Automated pipeline that turns a resume into a narrated video: scripted narration, TTS voiceover, subtitles, and assembled video.
Enrollment What-If Simulator - Python | Streamlit | github.com/sharmauncw/enrollment-whatif-simulator
Scenario-modeling tool for enrollment planning - adjust policy levers and project outcomes forward; no fitted models, no leakage.
WiFi Indoor Navigation System - Purdue ECE senior capstone (Spring 2015)
Indoor positioning system that fuses multiple sensor techniques (including WiFi) to navigate an object indoors, where GPS signals
can't penetrate; built by a team of 4 - Sidharth Mudgal, Akanksha Sharma, Suppatach Sabpisal, Daulet Kenzhebalin (Group 7).
Purdue course archive record: https://engineering.purdue.edu/ece477/Archive/archive.php (select Spring 2015, Group 7).
Banner-Style Datamart SQL Patterns - SQL | github.com/sharmauncw/banner-datamart-sql-patterns
Sanitized SQL reporting patterns for higher-ed datamarts - cohort definitions, retention, DFW rates, course-outcome analysis.

E D U C AT I O N

Doctor of Information Technology, Trine University Jun 2025 - Dec 2030 (expected)
GPA 4.00
Coursework: Data Science & Big Data; Computer Science with Python (A); Network Management (A); Graduate Internship. In
progress: Cybersecurity (DIT 7013, starting Oct 2026).
M.S., Management Information Systems, Oakland University Jan 2023 - Jun 2024
GPA 3.30
Selected by Prof. Vijayan Sugumaran to represent Oakland University at the 12th annual Great Lakes Data, AI & Analytics Summit
(Apr 18, 2024, Detroit Marriott Troy) - Michigan's only data & analytics summit of its kind, 350+ practitioners; attended with a
sponsored ticket as a student delegate alongside faculty and fellow students.
B.S., Computer Engineering, Purdue University Aug 2011 - Dec 2015
GPA 3.23
Dean's List; Society of Women Engineers award; Technicolor co-op (4 terms); full Stanford summer-school scholarship.

C E R T I F I C AT I O N S

Introduction to Cybersecurity Tools and Cyberattacks V3 - IBM (via Coursera) - Nov 2026 | Verify: credly.com/badges/1d53cb72-a946-4a34-abd3-6b1dfbfd119e
AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner - Jan 2024 - Jan 2027
Post Graduate Program in Data Science and Business Analytics, Texas McCombs School of Business

- Sep 2022
Professional coursework (Google): Grow as a Manager; Support Individual Growth and Development; Create a High-Performing
Team; Set and Achieve Team Goals - Jan 2026
PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT
PMP Exam Prep (coursework), uCertify - Jul 2025
PROFESSIONAL SERVICE
Proposal Reviewer - Association for Institutional Research (AIR), 2027 AIR Forum - Nov 2026
SKILLS
BI & Visualization: Power BI (DAX, Power Query, semantic modeling, row-level security), Tableau
Data: SQL, SQL Server (SSMS), Python, Jupyter, statistical analysis, data modeling, data quality & validation, AWS
Professional: Prompt engineering, project management, stakeholder collaboration, institutional research & planning

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